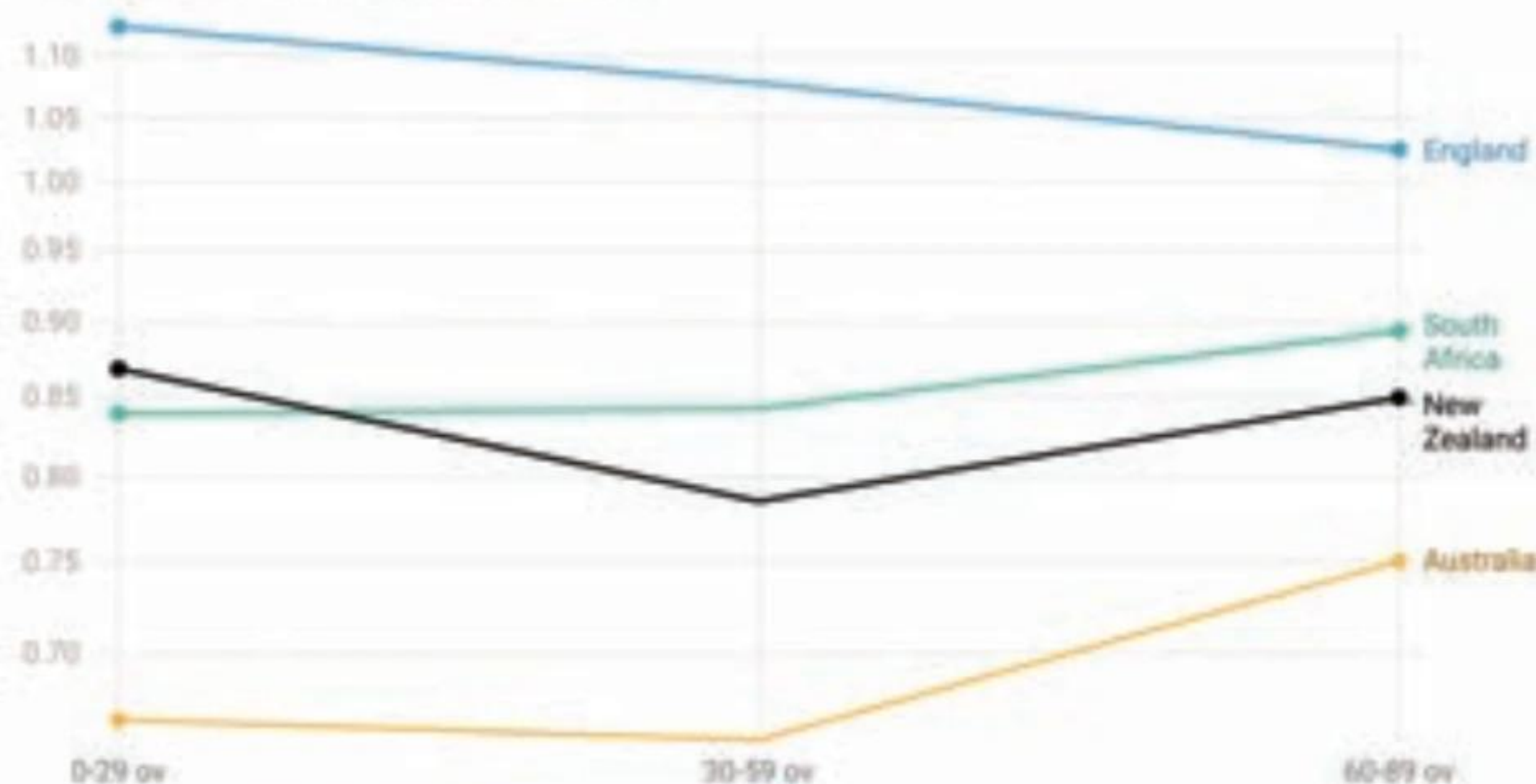


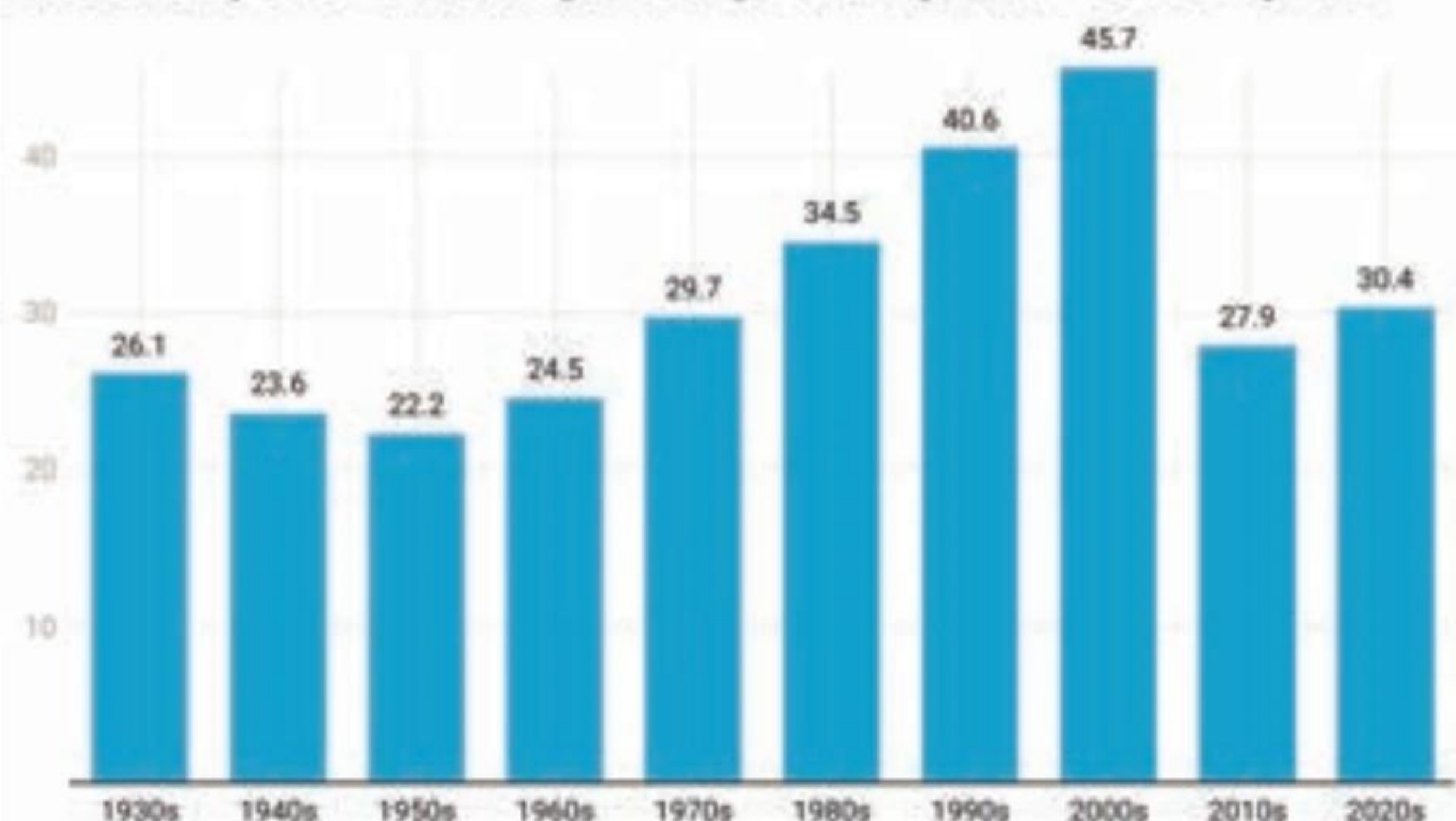
Average swing in Test cricket in SENA countries across ball age

X Axis - Ball age | Y Axis - Average swing



Based on all Test matches from 2005 with ball-tracking data (Cricviz)

Indian top-order batting average in England over the years



Top-order - From openers to number seven

Test teams' batting averages against different degrees of swing

Team	≤0.75°	0.75-1.50°	1.50-2.25°	2.25-3.00°	>3.00°
Australia	27	28.75	28.05	20.03	43.41
England	31.75	37.15	31.42	26.96	32.57
India	25.23	23.39	19.15	24.70	23.43
New Zealand	32.02	28.66	23.25	29.00	28.40
Pakistan	26.73	22.30	19.08	16.31	18.00
South Africa	30.07	28.16	19.44	49.25	11.00
Sri Lanka	27.44	23.07	25.20	18.00	34.66
West Indies	24.59	23.94	12.81	28.44	18.06

more pronounced when the ball swings less.

Since 2010, Indian top-seven batters in England average just 25.23 when the ball swings under 0.75° — only West Indies has done worse.

India's averages remain subpar even in higher swing brackets (0.75–1.50° and 1.50–2.25°).

Virat Kohli summed up the challenge of batting in England during the 2021 series:

"You can never say in England that now you are set. You have to put your ego in your pocket. You need good decision-making because conditions in England are the toughest in the world, in my opinion." Kohli's own journey in England was marked by extremes. In 2014, he averaged just 13.40 across five Tests. Four years later, he bounced back with a superb 593-run series, including two centuries and three fifties.

That turnaround, Kohli said, came from understanding that batting in England demands sustained focus:

"The conditions are not like in other places where, once you reach 30 or 40, you can start picking balls to hit. In England, you have to bat the way you did for your first 30 runs and repeat the same template for as long as possible.

This discipline and patience are essential. If you're not patient in England, you can get out at any time — regardless of your experience or the number of runs you have."

While this advice is sound in theory, executing it is far from easy — especially for a largely inexperienced Indian line-up in 2025. Yashasvi Jaiswal, Karun Nair, Nitish Kumar Reddy, Sai Sudharsan, Dhruv Jurel, Abhimanyu Easwaran, and Washington Sundar are all yet to play a Test in England.

One small consolation for the visitor is the absence of England's legendary swing duo — James Anderson and Stuart Broad. The pair has taken a combined 169 wickets against India at home, at an average of just 23.41.

Even so, for Gill and company, this series promises to be as tough a baptism as Test cricket gets.